

Doubt shadows peace process with Iran

Trump is signaling optimism, but the deal would require major U.S. concessions.

By MICHAEL WILNER

WASHINGTON — A framework agreement to end the U.S. war with Iran is all but settled, pending sign-off from the presidents of the two warring sides, President Trump said Friday, projecting optimism that a deal could finally be at hand.

Yet doubt cast a shadow over the diplomatic process entering the weekend as Trump faced a politically fraught decision to enter an agreement that would invariably require significant concessions to Tehran.

The negotiations have faced severe headwinds in recent days, with both sides accusing the other of violating a fragile ceasefire that has largely stopped the fighting since April.

On his Truth Social site, Trump said he had summoned his top aides to the White House Situation Room to decide on the deal. By Friday evening, no decision on signing the deal had been announced.

The agreement would see an end to the U.S. naval blockade on Iranian ports and the removal of Iranian mines from the Strait of Hormuz, an international waterway through which 20% of the world's energy supply passes each day. The strait, Trump wrote, will reopen with "no tolls" for "unrestricted shipping traffic, in both directions."

[See Iran, A6]

Extreme violence redefined MS-13

Ritualistic machete slayings are said to be linked to adoption of code to prove loyalty.

By GAVIN J. QUINTON

Angel Guzman had been locked up for years, awaiting trial in one of the most grisly gang murder cases in Los Angeles history, when prosecutors say he chose a new tattoo.

The black image, inked across his chest, showed a human heart gripped by long, clawlike fingers.

To federal prosecutors, the tattoo was evidence of the crime Guzman stood accused of committing. In the Angeles National Forest in 2017, authorities say, Guzman killed and hacked up the body of Juan Jose Sibrian, carving out his heart and tossing his remains over the edge of a canyon.

The killing, prosecutors told jurors at Guzman's trial in a downtown Los Angeles courtroom this month, was the consequence of a violent transformation inside MS-13's Fulton clique, a San Fernando Valley subset described as one of the gang's most violent factions in the United States.

For most of the gang's history, Assistant U.S. Atty. Suria Bahadue told the jury, its L.A. chapters allowed young MS-13 associates to rise through the ranks by selling drugs, robbing people, carrying out beatings or putting in other "work."

[See MS-13, A7]



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times



TOMAS OVALLE For The Times



SARA NEVIS For The Times

FROM TOP: Democratic front-runner Xavier Becerra speaks to a union crowd in Bloomington; Republican Steve Hilton attends a campaign rally in Clovis; and Democrat Tom Steyer poses for a photo with supporters in West Sacramento.

Questions deepen over Altadena fire evacuation

New 911 records show officials were aware of dangers

By GRACE TOOHEY

Los Angeles County sheriff's deputies evacuated a resident in west Altadena just after 11:30 the night the Eaton fire broke out, according to logs of 911 calls obtained by The Times, raising new questions about why it took nearly four more hours for authorities to issue widespread alerts for the rest of the community.

The records show this early evacuation was run up the chain of command, meaning officials handling the emergency should have been aware of it. It also came as fire crews reported an ac-

tive fire in the same area.

The logs add to growing evidence that both fire and sheriff personnel on the ground during the first hours of the blaze knew it was threatening Altadena neighborhoods west of Lake Avenue well before the 3:25 a.m. evacuation order was issued.

In the end, all but one of the 19 people who died in the Eaton fire were found in west Altadena, where the fire damage was most concentrated. No evacuation warnings went out to that area before evacuations were ordered.

The new 911 records come a week after the L.A. County

Fire Department released a report that concluded there was "no failure" or delay in how evacuations rolled out. County officials heralded the investigation for providing new details from the chaotic first hours of the firestorm, which highlighted incident commanders' lack of situational awareness.

The Times first reported that many Altadena residents evacuated in dangerous conditions without any warnings or on-the-ground aid in January 2025. Some have blamed the late alerts for their loved ones' deaths. Earlier this year, California Atty. Gen. Rob Bonta

[See Records, A7]



J. DAVID AKE Getty Images

NAME CHANGE STOPPED

A federal judge orders the removal of President Trump's name from the Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts in Washington. **NATION, A5**

Ex-mayor guilty in China scandal

Eileen Wang, who once led Arcadia, takes plea deal for acting as an illegal agent of Beijing. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Fired reporter speaking out

Former "60 Minutes" journalist said she faced censorship, pressure to insert political bias into stories. **BUSINESS, A10**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 77/59. **B8**



Candidates in homestretch of governor's race

Front-runners Becerra, Hilton and Steyer woo voters in friendly political territory.

By NICOLE NIXON, SEEMA MEHTA AND DAKOTA SMITH

The top candidates for California governor crisscrossed the state Friday, all venturing to friendly political territory to woo voters and undermine their rivals as the June 2 primary election fast approaches.

The top Republican in the race, former Fox News host Steve Hilton, spent the day railing against transgender athletes before a high school track event in the Central Valley, an event sure to appeal to his base of President Trump supporters.

The front-running Democrats, former Biden administration Cabinet member Xavier Becerra and billionaire environmentalist Tom Steyer, rallied one of their party's most influential constituencies: union members.

While both stuck with

Challenger's mom bankrolls his bid

Zach Sokoloff is challenging incumbent City Controller Kenneth Mejia. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Two supervisor seats up for grabs

Lindsey Horvath seeks reelection in District 3. Five candidates vie in District 1. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

mostly an upbeat message and reiterated promises to lift up Californians struggling to make ends meet, Steyer afterward accused Becerra of being "a corporate Democrat who's taking money from all these big corporations" who "doesn't want to change things."

Steyer's had good reason to go after Becerra.

A new poll from the UC Berkeley Institute of Governmental Studies that was co-sponsored by the Los Angeles Times showed Becerra leading the race with 25% support from likely voters, followed by Hilton at 21%

[See Homestretch, A9]

Charter school wars may be over

Bitter and expensive L.A. board races of the past are absent this election cycle.

By HOWARD BLUME

This election cycle marks the end to a generation of bitterly contested Los Angeles school board races that became the most expensive in the country, with the L.A. teachers union and charter school advocates slugging it out to advance their vision for public education.

The difference?

Charter school supporters — who had poured tens of million of dollars into races to elect board members sympathetic to their cause — have largely stepped aside, a reflection of shifting finances and strategy in California and nationally.

Three of seven Board of Education seats are on the ballot Tuesday in comparatively low-spending contests with incumbents as over-

whelming favorites. The charter association's political arm has not mounted campaigns in support of anyone.

East San Fernando Valley incumbent Kelly Gonez faces one challenger, Jose Sagredo, who as a write-in candidate will not even have his name on the ballot.

The two other incumbents, Nick Melvoin and Rocio Rivas, both face challengers with extremely limited campaign resources and no special-interest financial backing.

Since the early 2000s, the rise of charter schools has been a central narrative in Los Angeles public schools. Charters are privately operated, mostly nonunion public schools that compete for students with district-operated campuses. Starting in the early 1990s, charters gradually took hold in L.A., convincing parents they offered an attractive education alternative; they now enroll about 1 in 5 public school students living within L.A. Unified boundaries.

[See Schools, A9]

Voices STEVE LOPEZ COLUMNIST

Rep. Waters says 'no' to Compton schools

In a mailer, longtime L.A. congresswoman opposes a district bond measure. Why?

ters' Sample Ballot and Voter Recommendations," he couldn't believe her advice on Measure CPT.

Vote "no."

Given Waters' stature as a congressional representative for 35 years, Ali said, her slate mailers can swing outcomes.

"Yes, it does carry weight," Ali said, and the thumbs-down recommendation "can literally cripple our ability to pass this bond."

Ali was doubly surprised because the mailers went out to voters just a few weeks after Waters attended a groundbreaking ceremony for the future Centennial High School campus. District alums and hip-hop heavyweights Kendrick Lamar and Dr. Dre joined the celebration, and the latter was honored for his \$10-million donation to the new performing arts center at Compton High, which recently opened a new campus.

[See Lopez, A9]